

Prayer for the Dead

A labor of love

Those who love remember. Those who remember, pray.

An explanation of about Prayer for the Dead.

Various prayers for the dead, for use at home or in church.

Scripture concerning the dead.

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This Document:

<http://www.orthodox.net/catechism/prayer-for-the-dead+explanations-and-prayers.doc>

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Why do we pray for the dead? What do we expect because of our prayer?

We pray for the dead, because no person is dead in God's eyes (our Lord said: " God is the God of the living, and not of the dead",) and because of love.

Love never forgets. Some people are hung up about prayer for the dead, but there is no need to be.

We love and therefore we remember and pray. We pray with love and expectation. God knows all things and we do not know much. He has revealed very little to us about the state of our soul in the interim period between the death of the body and the reintegration of the soul with the body at the end of the age. The Orthodox way is to not over analyze, but to pray!

Seven important things to know about prayer for the dead.

All a Christian really needs to know about the dead and prayer for the dead is this:

1. We believe in the resurrection. God is the God of the Living, and not of the dead, our Lord told us, and we believe this truth. If this is true, then the dead have not ceased to exist, because "all are alive to God." Praying for the dead, as much as asking the dead (those whom we believe to be righteous) to intercede for us shows that we really do believe in the resurrection.
2. We do not understand all that occurs after death because all things have not been revealed to us. We know that "all men have sinned and fallen short of the glory of God", and there is "not one man who liveth and sinneth not", and we (at least as a church, if not individually) are profoundly humble. **How can we know the judgments of God? They are a vast abyss. We do not presume to declare that one is blessed and another is damned.** God knows, and only rarely reveals to us this with certainty.
3. Those who love continue to love even after the one they love dies.
4. Those who love, remember, and those who remember pray because prayer is the ultimate expression of love, and not only this, if we do not pray for a person we say we love, we are liars. For Christians, it is impossible to love someone and not to pray. It does not matter if a person is alive or dead, a believer or nonbeliever, if we love them we will be praying for them.

5. The one they love, upon the death of the body, remains alive, conscious and sentient in the soul. The “sleep of death” refers to the body being dead, and that at the Second coming, a perfected body will be reunited with the soul, and the corrupted body will rise as if it had only been sleeping.

6. We place our hope in the mercy of God, and pray because we love. One who loves does not need a reason to pray, or require a detailed explanation of the effects of their prayer. We cannot know the infinite abyss that is the mercies and judgment of God.

7. Prayer for the dead will always comfort the dead, and those who pray. Prayer is always the answer for everything, and sometimes, it is the only answer. How often should you pray? It is a terrible mistake for an Orthodox Christian to think that their responsibility in praying for the dead is only to bring their commemoration book whenever they come to liturgy. When they do this, they are asking the priest to pray for them (instead of them). They should be praying with the priest, by praying for their loved one daily. Most people do not have a long list of the reposed that they pray for, so it is quite easy to pray for them daily. It is best to pray for each one individually, but they can be prayed for in groups as well. It is best to pray with a prostration, but any prayer, done consistently, is heard by God.

To summarize “why do we pray for the dead”: **We pray for the dead because, knowing the weakness of flesh and man’s predilection to sin, we hope in the resurrection, leaving all judgment to God, and because we love, we remember, and because we remember, we pray.**

(Adapted from http://www.orthodox.net/full-voice/prison-ministry-letters_2015-07-09+praying-for-the-dead+when-things-are-hard.doc & : <http://www.orthodox.net/journal/2010-02-11-saturday-of-the-dead+all-souls-saturday+why-do-we-pray-for-the-dead.doc> See also: <http://www.orthodox.net/catechesis/catechetical-letter-03+prayer-to-the-saints-because-of-the-resurrection.doc>)

For those who desire or require more knowledge, a more detailed replantation about prayer for the dead is below.

The fate of man after death

Death is the inevitable end of all organic life on earth, including human life. But from the Christian point of view, the death of a person is not a normal or necessary phenomenon. On the contrary, human death is the result of the disobedience of our first parents. God warned Adam about the fruits of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil: "For in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die" (Gen. 2:17). From Adam death was passed on to his descendants.

A man's death, however, is not the annihilation of his identity, but only the destruction of his physical shell. The words: "For dust thou art, and unto dust shalt thou return" (Gen. 3:19) refer to the human body. The soul of a person, as that which carries within itself the image and likeness of the Creator, is eternal: "Then shall the dust return to the earth as it was: and the spirit shall return unto God who gave it" (Eccl. 12:7). After its separation from the body, the soul continues to think, feel and act, but in another world, one unlike our material world.

What, then, happens to a man's soul after its separation from the body? Man is given life in order to learn how to believe, to do good, and to develop his talents. All of these things make up his spiritual riches, or, in the words of the Savior, his "treasure in heaven." Death sums up the life of a person, and his soul must then come before God for an accounting, to receive its reward or punishment. But the judgment which follows soon after death is not yet the final judgment, because only the soul is being judged, without the body. About the existence of this preliminary judgment the Apostle Paul wrote: "It is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment" (Heb. 9:27). At the end of the world, after the universal resurrection of the dead, there will be the universal Last Judgment, at which God will judge all people simultaneously. Then each person will receive either eternal reward or eternal punishment with his or her resurrected body.

Concerning the particular (i.e., individual) judgment, the Orthodox Church teaches:

"We believe that the souls of the dead enjoy blessedness or suffer torment according to their deeds. Upon being separated from their bodies, they immediately pass over either into happiness or into sorrow and grief; however, they do not experience complete bliss or complete torture. For each one will receive perfect happiness or complete torture after the general resurrection, when the soul will be joined to the body in which it lived, whether virtuously or sinfully" (Epistle of the Eastern Patriarchs concerning the Orthodox faith, article 18).

Thus, there exist two states after death: one for the souls of the righteous, in paradise; the other for the souls of sinners, in hell. (The Orthodox Church does not accept the Roman Catholic teaching about an intermediate state in Purgatory. The church fathers usually attribute the word "Gehenna" to the state after the Last Judgment, when both death and hell will be cast into a fiery lake, cf. Rev. 20:15).

While a person lives, God gives him the chance to repent and correct his shortcomings. After death, the possibility of repentance is removed. Still, if a person dies and is not deserving of paradise, this does not mean that he is doomed to eternal torment. Until the Last Judgment, the torments of sinners in hell are temporary and can be relieved or even removed by the prayers of believing people and the Church (Epistle of the Eastern Patriarchs, article 18). Prayers for the dead always benefit them. If they were not deemed worthy of heaven, these prayers alleviate their fate beyond the grave, and if they are in paradise, these prayers give them joy and an increase of light. We will now explain why prayers for the dead have such power.

The necessity of praying for the dead

In order to appreciate the power of prayers for the dead, it must be understood that death interrupts only the physical contact among people; spiritual contact continues. This contact is realized through prayer. The Gospel teaches us that prayer, coupled with faith,

has great power. In the words of our Lord, it can even move mountains. The Lord Jesus Christ and His apostles taught Christians to pray for one another.

The Gospels and the other books of the New Testament contain numerous examples of how the prayers of some helped others. Thus, according to the faith of the nobleman, the Lord healed his son (John 4:46-53); by the faith of the Canaanite woman her possessed daughter was healed (Mt. 15:21-28); by the faith of a father his possessed son, who was deaf and mute, was healed (Mk. 9:17-27); at the request of friends the Lord forgave and healed the paralytic, whom they lowered from the roof with ropes (Mk. 2:2-12); and by the faith of the Roman centurion his servant was healed (Mt. 8:5-13). Furthermore, the Lord performed most of these miraculous healings at a distance, in absentia. The Holy Evangelist John the Theologian urges us to turn to God in prayer, with faith that God will fulfill our request. As he says, "And this is the confidence that we have in Him [the Son of God], that, if we ask any thing according to His will, He heareth us" (1 John 5:14).

Since prayer possesses the power of grace, it knows no boundaries and does not grow weaker with distance. It is the result of love, and, like a ray of light, it penetrates men's souls, uniting those who pray with God and with one another. An ancient story teaches a good lesson. Once St. Macarius of Egypt found a human skull while walking in the desert. When Abba Macarius touched the skull with a palm branch, a voice came from the skull. When the elder asked, "Who are you?" the skull answered, "I was a pagan priest and lived in this place. Abba Macarius, have pity on us who are in eternal torment, and pray for us, for your prayer brings us comfort." The elder asked, "What comfort comes to you from my prayers?" The skull answered, "When you pray for us, light appears, and we begin to see one another."

Thus, prayer joins our world with another world, where the angels, the saints and our departed relatives and friends dwell. Since the moment of the resurrection of Christ death has lost its former fatality; instead, it has become the beginning of a new life. Now, as St. Paul teaches: "Neither death, nor life...nor height, nor depth...shall be able to separate us from the love of God... For whether we live, we live unto the Lord; and whether we die, we die unto the Lord; whether we live, therefore, or die, we are the Lord's. For to this end Christ both died, and rose, and revived, that He might be Lord

both of the dead and living" (Rom. 8:38-39; Rom. 14:8-9). For this reason, it is not only possible, but even necessary, to pray for the dead as well as for the living; for, according to the words of the Savior, to God all are alive (cf. Lk. 20:38).

Christians who have departed from this world do not sever their ties to the Church to which they belonged during their life. If they are righteous, they have the freedom to pray for us at the throne of God; if imperfect, they require our prayers. The Apostle Paul compared the Church to a high mountain, whose base rests on the earth while its peak reaches the sky. "But ye come unto mount Sion, and unto the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to an innumerable company of angels, to the general assembly and church of the firstborn, which are written in heaven, and to God the Judge of all, and to the spirits of just men made perfect, and to Jesus the mediator of the new covenant" (Heb. 12:22-24). In other words, according to the apostle, between the earthly and the heavenly Church there exists a living and close relationship. Faith in this unity and in the power of prayer serves as the basis for a practice which goes back to the apostolic age: to maintain ties with the dead, to turn to the holy martyrs and the saints with prayers for help, and also to remember the dead at the Proskomedie and in prayers for their repose.

Christian comfort for the sorrowing

When a person near and dear to us departs from us, how can we not sorrow? The Lord Jesus Christ Himself sorrowed and even shed tears when His friend Lazarus died. Yet a natural sorrow at someone's death should not cast a Christian into despondency or cause him to murmur against God. Death is not the destruction of a person, but only the temporary separation of the soul from the body. Since it is a temporary condition, the New Testament Holy Scriptures and the early Christian writings refer to death as "sleep" (Acts 13:36) or "Dormition (falling asleep)," as in the name of the feast of the Dormition of the Mother of God. Death is called sleep in relation to the body; the soul of the dead person continues its conscious life. Its mental and other spiritual faculties do not weaken after death; on the contrary, they receive greater lightness and mobility, not being constricted by the body.

In order not to sorrow excessively over the loss of a loved one, we should consider that physical death also has a positive aspect. It brings man relief from his daily labors and from all the sorrows, illnesses and fears which fill our earthly existence. It is a passage to a better world, where eternal light shines, where the truth of God reigns, where there is no grief, and where the souls of the faithful find everlasting joy and peace.

The main source of comfort for a Christian should be that all of us will rise from the dead, meet those dear to us and live eternally. The Son of God came to earth to restore to the human race the immortal life which it had lost because of sin. The Resurrection of our Lord Jesus Christ is the beginning of our resurrection. We celebrate the feast of Pascha (Easter) with such joy because "we celebrate the annihilation of death, the destruction of Hell, the beginning of another life, which is eternal" (from the Paschal Canon).

The Apostle Paul comforts Christians who have lost their loved ones in these words: "But I would not have you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope. For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him" (1 Thes. 4:13-14). The Apostle further explains that we who remain among the living will not receive our reward before those who have died, because the fullness of the reward will come to all the righteous at the same time: "For this we say unto you by the word of the Lord, that we which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent [i.e., go before] them which are asleep. For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first: Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord" (1 Thess. 4:15-18).

Elsewhere, the Apostle sets forth the Christian view of life and death in these words: "For we know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens. For in this we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed upon with our house which is from heaven: if so be that being clothed we shall not be found naked. For we that are in this tabernacle do

groan, being burdened: not for that we would be unclothed, but clothed upon, that mortality might be swallowed up of life. Now he that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God, who also hath given unto us the earnest of the Spirit. Therefore, we are always confident, knowing that whilst we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord: (For we walk by faith, not by sight:) We are confident, I say, and willing rather to be absent from the body, and to be present with the Lord" (2 Cor. 5:1-8).

These and similar thoughts will be our comfort when we lose people dear to us. Their transfer to another world reminds us that our own end is approaching. Therefore, in praying for them let us pray for ourselves as well, that we may be counted worthy of a Christian ending to our life, painless, blameless and peaceful, and that we may receive a favorable verdict at the dread judgment seat of Christ.

Orthodox memorial days

From ancient times it has been an established custom to remember the dead on the third, ninth and fortieth days after their repose, and also on the anniversary of death or on the name day of the deceased. There are also certain days in the year which the Church dedicates to the commemoration of all the faithful departed; these are called the Memorial Saturdays. On Meat-fare Saturday, during the carnival season before Lent, in connection with the commemoration of the coming dread Judgment Day, the Church prays for all who have died throughout the ages. Then, on the second, third and fourth Saturdays of Lent (Greek usage also Cheesefare Saturday and 1st Saturday of Lent), and on the Saturday before Pentecost, the Church prays particularly for all those who died unprepared or suddenly, for criminals who were condemned to death, for the homeless, for those who were deprived of Christian burial, for those who were torn apart by wild animals, for those who were swallowed up by the sea, etc., and finally for all our fathers and forefathers from ages past.

In addition, since ancient times it has been customary to submit in church books of commemoration with the names of the living and the dead. During Great Lent memorial services are offered after the regular daily services. It is also customary to visit the graves of our relatives on the second Tuesday after Pascha, the day called Radonitsa,

and to offer services at the cemetery with the singing of the Paschal hymn, "Christ is risen."

In Russia there are also days set aside for the commemoration of Orthodox soldiers killed in battle: September 11, the commemoration of the Beheading of Saint John the Baptist; and Saint Demetrius Saturday, the Saturday before the feast of Saint Demetrius of Thessalonica, which is observed on November 8 (N.S.) Saint Demetrius Saturday was instituted by Dimitri Donskoy after the Battle of Kulikovo Field in 1380.

Thus, the Church is constantly showing its concern for the salvation of its children. Even after they have left this physical world behind, the Church entreats God on their behalf. The saints, who have attained the state of the Church Triumphant, pray, in turn, for their younger brethren of the Church Militant. The Apostle Saint John the Theologian writes of this in the book of Revelation (cf. Rev. 8:4). Let us, then, follow the commandment of our Savior and pray for one another, including those who have departed, with the firm belief that these prayers will bring us, and them, great benefit.

Bishop Alexander (Mileant) Translated by Nikolai and Natalie Semianko /Fr. Herman Ciuba

Prayers for the Dead

Here is a good prayer to say for the dead every day.

Prayer for every departed person

Remember, O Lord our God, Thy servant, our *brother/sister, N.*, who has reposed in the Faith and hope of life eternal, and in that Thou art good and the Lover of mankind, Who remittest sins and blottest out iniquities, do Thou loose, remit and pardon all *his/her* sins, voluntary and involuntary.

Deliver *him/her* from eternal torment and the fire of Gehenna, and grant unto *him/her* the communion and delight of Thine eternal good things prepared for them that love Thee.

For though *he/she* hath sinned, yet hath *he/she* not forsaken Thee, and *he/she* undoubtedly believed in the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit; and even until *his/her* last breath did *he/she* confess Thee in Orthodox fashion: God glorified in Trinity, Unity in Trinity and Trinity in Unity.

Wherefore, be Thou merciful unto *him/her* and reckon *his/her* faith in Thee, rather than *his/her* deeds, and in that Thou art compassionate, grant him/her rest with Thy saints; for there is no man that liveth and doth not sin.

But Thou alone art wholly without sin, and Thy truth is forever; and Thou alone art the God of mercies, and compassion, and love for mankind, and unto Thee do we ascribe glory, to the Father, and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto ages of ages. Amen.

In the back of the "Boston" Psalter. http://www.synaxis.info/psalter/5_english/b_reading/kath_prayers.html

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-every-departed-person-in-the-psalter.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-every-departed-person-in-the-psalter.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-every-departed-person-in-the-psalter.html>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-every-departed-person-in-the-psalter-card.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-every-departed-person-in-the-psalter-card.pdf>

O God of Spirits and of all flesh...

From the Funeral & Panikhida service

O God of spirits and of all flesh, Who hast trampled down death, and overthrown the devil, and given life to Thy world:

Do Thou, Thyself, or Lord give rest to the **soul(s)** of Thy departed **servant(s)** _____,

in a place of light, a place of green pasture, a place of repose, whence all sickness, sorrow and sighing are fled away.

Pardon every sin committed by **him (her, them)**, in word, deed or thought, in that Thou art a good God, the Lover of mankind;

For there is no man that liveth and sinneth not, for Thou alone art without sin, Thy righteousness is an everlasting righteousness, and Thy Word in Truth.

For Thou art the Resurrection, and the Life, and the repose of Thy departed **servant(s)** _____, O Christ our God, and to Thee we send up glory, together with Thine Unoriginate Father, and Thy most holy and good and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and to the ages of ages.

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/prayer-for-the-dead-o-god-of-spirits-es.rtf>

See other prayers & services at <http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic> or <http://www.orthodox.net/services>

Alleluia for the Departed

(from the Requiem Matins or Panikhida, 8th Tone)

Refrain: Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia

Verse. Blessed are they whom Thou hast chosen and taken, O Lord. **(Refrain)**

Verse. Their memory is from generation to generation. **(Refrain)**

Verse. Their souls will dwell amid good things. **(Refrain)**

Troparion for the departed

Tone VIII

O Thou Who by the depth of Thy wisdom dost provide all things out of love for man, / and grantest unto all that which is profitable, O only Creator: / Grant rest, O Lord, to the souls of Thy servants; // for in Thee have they placed their hope, O our Creator and Fashioner and God.

Kontakion for the departed

Tone VIII, special melody

With the saints give rest, / O Christ, / to the souls of Thy servants, / where there is neither sickness, nor sorrow, / nor sighing, // but life everlasting.

One can also "pray a rope" for the dead

"Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, grant rest to the soul of Thy departed **servant (Name)**"

It is best to do a set number of these prayers for the departed, such as 12, with a full prostration at each prayer.

Priest: **Blessed is our God...**

Then: Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us *(3 times)*

Choose 1: (which is usually done) or 2:

1:

Troparia 4th Tone: With the souls of the righteous that have finished their course, give rest, O Saviour, to the soul(s) of Thy servant(s), preserving him *(her/them)* in the blessed life which is with Thee, O Lover of mankind.

In the place of Thy rest, O Lord, where all Thy saints repose, give rest also to the soul(s) of Thy servant(s), for Thou alone art the Lover of Mankind.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

Thou art the God Who descended into hades and loosed the chains of the captives; do Thou Thyself give rest also to the soul(s) of Thy servant(s).

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O only pure and blameless Virgin, who without seed gavest birth to God, pray that his *(her/their)* soul(s) be saved.

2:

Kontakion for the Departed, in Tone VIII

With the saints give rest, * O Christ, * to the soul(s) of Thy servant(s), * where there is neither sickness, nor sorrow, nor sighing, * but life everlasting.

Ikos:

Thou alone art immortal, * Who didst create and fashion man; * but we mortals were formed of earth, * and unto earth shall we return, * as Thou who madest me didst command and say unto me: * For earth thou art and unto earth shalt thou return, * whither all we mortals are going, * making as a funeral dirge the song: * Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

Then the Requiem litany

(File:C:\www\orthodox.net\services\litya-with-requiem-litany.doc)

The Requiem Litany

Deacon: Have mercy on us, O God, according to Thy great mercy, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy. Chanters: Lord, have mercy (3x)

-- Again we pray for the repose of the departed servants of God, *N.N.*, and that they may be forgiven every transgression, both voluntary and involuntary. (Response)

--That the Lord God commit their souls to where the righteous repose.
(Response)

The priest saith this prayer secretly:

O God of spirits and of all flesh, Who hast trampled down death, and overthrown the devil, and given life to Thy world: Do Thou Thyself, O Lord, give rest to the souls of Thy departed servants, *N.N.*, in a place of light, a place of green pasture, a place of repose, whence all sickness, sorrow and sighing are fled away. Pardon

--The mercy of God, the kingdom of Heaven, and the remission of their sins, let us ask of Christ the Immortal King and our God.

Chanters: Grant this, O Lord.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord

Chanters: Lord, have mercy.

every sin committed by them in word, deed, or thought, in that Thou art a good God, the Lover of mankind; for there is no man that liveth and sinneth not, for Thou alone art without sin, Thy righteousness is an everlasting righteousness, and Thy word is truth.

Priest: **For Thou art the Resurrection, and the life, and the repose of Thy departed servants *N.N.*, O Christ our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory, together with Thine unoriginate Father, and Thy most holy and good and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.** Chanters: Amen. *File:C:\www\orthodox.net\services\litya-with-requiem-litany.doc*



(italics are additions of Priest Seraphim)

O Holy, wondrous Martyr Varus, who, burning with zeal for the Heavenly King, didst confess Him before thy torturers and didst greatly suffer for Him!

Now the Church doth venerate thee, as one glorified with the glory of heaven by Christ the Lord, Who granted thee the abundant grace to approach Him boldly.

And now, standing before Him together with the Angels, rejoicing on high, beholding the Most Holy Trinity clearly, and enjoying the Uncreated Light, remember the suffering of our relatives *(and those we remember, and*

those we hold in our hearts) who have died outside the Faith, and accept our pleas, and as thou didst intercede for the unbelieving ancestors of Cleopatra and didst free them from eternal suffering,

remember those who have died unbaptized or have been buried in an ungodly manner, *or died suddenly, or by their own hand, or unjustly,*

N.N.

.... and pray earnestly that they may be delivered from eternal darkness, that we may all, with one mouth and one heart, praise the Most Merciful Creator unto the ages of ages. Amen.

The Holy Martyr Varus is commemorated on October 19. The Life recounts how after his martyrdom his relics were taken by Cleopatra & placed within a church. There she continually prayed for his intercessions. At one point when her son died & she challenged the saint why he had let this happen after all her efforts for the saint, he replied that he continually prayed for her unbelieving ancestors, "with whom", the Life says, "you buried me."

We must always pray for those who died outside of the Church especially those of our own family. We do not commemorate them at the Liturgy but certainly we should pray for them during our prayers at home.

Just think how many even nominal Christians do not pray for the departed or just simply forget to do so. How terrible if a reposed soul was simply forgotten about and no one prayed for him! If prayer is an aspect of our love for others, then the prayer of the Faithful must be a source of great consolation for those reposed who would otherwise be completely forgotten.

A last thought is that though it is 'private prayer', since we are still members of the Church, this prayer is still the prayer of the Church, even though expressed in a different manner from the Liturgy. Thus it is still a powerful prayer for the reposed.

<http://www.monachos.net/conversation/topic/13-prayer-for-non-orthodox-deceased/>

Scripture read when commemorating the departed.

Romans 6.6-9 (Mon)

1 Corinthians 15.39-57 (Tue)

2 Corinthians 5.1-10 (Wed)

1 Corinthians 15.20-28 (Thu)

1 Corinthians 15.47-57 (Fri)

1 Thessalonians 4.13-17 (Sat)

John 5.17-24 (Mon)

John 5.24-30 (Tue, Sat)

John 6.35-39 (Wed)

John 6.40-44 (Thu)

John 6.48-54 (Fri)

But I would not have you to be ignorant, brethren, concerning them which are asleep, that ye sorrow not, even as others which have no hope. (14) For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so them also which sleep in Jesus will God bring with him. (15) For this we say unto you by the word of the Lord, that we which are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord shall not prevent them which are asleep. (16) For the Lord

himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first: (17) Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord. (18) Wherefore comfort one another with these words. ^{1Th} 4:13-18 KJV

Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life. (25) Verily, verily, I say unto you, The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God: and they that hear shall live. (26) For as the Father hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself; (27) And hath given him authority to execute judgment

also, because he is the Son of man. (28) Marvel not at this: for the hour is coming, in the which all that are in the graves shall hear his voice, (29) And shall come forth; they that have done good, unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil, unto the resurrection of damnation. (30) I can of mine own self do nothing: as I hear, I judge: and my judgment is just; because I seek not mine own will, but the will of the Father which hath sent me. John 5:24-30 KJV